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Petscop

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"Alright, so, uh... this is just to, um, prove to you that I'm not lying about this game that I found..."

— Paul, in the first video

[Petscop](#) is a series of [YouTube](#) videos chronicling someone's bizarre experiences with a mysterious and unfinished [PlayStation](#) game known as the titular *Petscop*. The first video was uploaded on March 12, 2017.

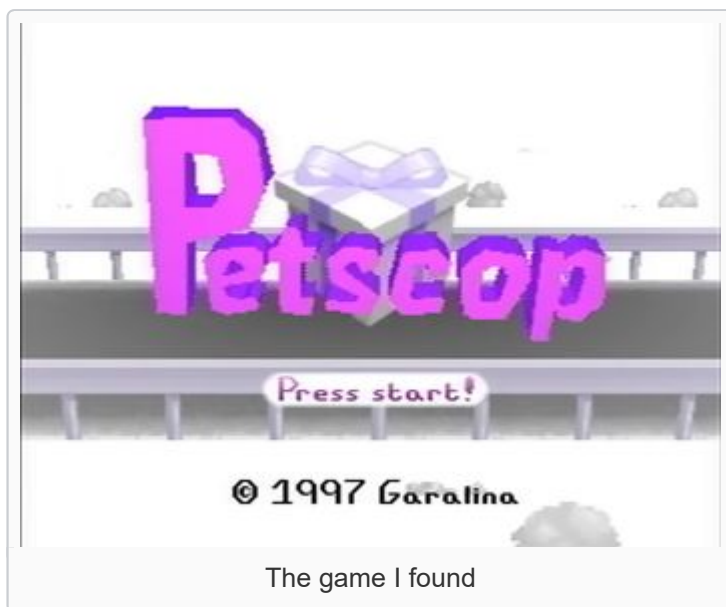
The series begins with the uploader of the videos, known as "Paul," saying he found the game with a strange note attached and wants to show a secret he discovered. At first, the

game starts off normally, with Paul traversing through a colorful and cheery world with the goal of [collecting](#) the creatures known as "[pets](#)." However, once Paul inputs a code written on the note, it becomes clear that there is much more to be uncovered about the game...

After years of anonymity, the project's sole creator, [Tony Domenico](#), revealed himself in November 2019. On Thanksgiving 2019, the series officially concluded with a total of 24 videos and [a soundtrack](#).

There is a fanmade recreation, *Giftscop*, found [here](#) which allows you to play the game yourself.

See also [Nifty](#), a loose predecessor; [Sheriff Domestic](#), a fanmade parody of the series; and [Household Felony](#), a [Spiritual Successor](#).



The game I found

Petscop shows examples of the following tropes:

- **Aborted Arc:** Early Petscop videos had allusions to the tragedy of Candace Newmaker, leading many, further fueled by Game Theory, to believe the entire game was meant as an allegory for it. While yes, the references *were* intentional, they became an **Old Shame** for the creator that he regretted doing, and were dropped by the time of Petscop 11.
- **Abusive Parents:** Once things go dark, this becomes the **Central Theme**. This is best shown with Marvin, as, from what we get in the in-game notes,
- **Aerith and Bob:** Some of the pets have strange names like Pen, Wavey, Roneth and Toneth... but then you have Amber and Randice.
- **All There in the Manual:** Once the series was finished, Tony finally added subtitles to every video. The subtitles confirm that
- **Amazing Technicolor Population:** Character colours in the game range from green, to blue, to purple, to red, to yellow, to pink.
- **Ambiguous Gender:**
 - Some of the Pets have this: Randice (due to not having facial features, like the rest, and its description is never shown), Wavey (its description is never shown as well) and Roneth (because it hasn't been caught yet).
 - Technically the game's protagonist, since neither "Paul" or the game ever refer to it directly.
- **Ambiguous Syntax:** The game/series' title itself, as it's not exactly clear what it means. Either "Pet's Cop" or "Pet Scop".
- **Ambiguous Situation:**

 - At one point during Petscop 14,
- **Anachronic Order:** Petscop 1 through 10 seem to be in chronological order. Everything afterward is suspect due to the inclusion of demo footage. Paul uses some of that footage to explore new areas, but his movements also appear later in those demo videos that were presumably recorded before he even started playing. Furthermore, Petscop 22 continues directly after Petscop 10. Sections without Paul speaking may or may not have been recorded by him.
- **And Now for Someone Completely Different:** An increasing number of later videos feature gameplay from players other than Paul.
- **And the Adventure Continues:**
- **Anti Poop-Socking:** The game's pause screen leaves the rather goofy message of "Your butt leaves a cavity in the chair," at the end of Petscop 20, which is likely an attempt to get people to stand up and do something else if they've been playing for a while.

- **Arc Symbol:**

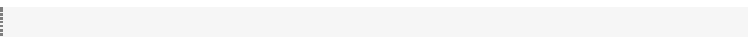
- The tool. It is a giant object that serves as **Mr. Exposition** which Paul can ask questions to, and several other smaller tools appear throughout the game serving various purposes.
- The house, school, and windmill are the three most prominent and important locations in the series.
- Later videos would add cars and wheels, which appear repeatedly, hinting at a car accident playing a role in the backstory.

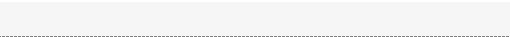
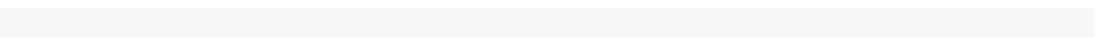
- **Arc Words:**

- "Newmaker," the title of Rainer and the **Player Character**, and the "Newmaker Plane," the **Dark World** below the Gift Plane and primary setting of the series.
- "**Rebirthing**" , and, related, "Do you remember being born?", a question frequently asked by Tiara.

- **Armless Biped:** All forms of the player character are armless - they actually share an identical armless torso sprite. At one point it's mentioned (and later confirmed) that the guardian doesn't know how to open doors due to this. A popular theory is that they're wearing straitjackets.
- **Art Shift:** After Paul inputs the code written on the note and leaves the first level, the art style suddenly shifts from a cheery, bright and colorful world to a dark field with more realistic graphics and thick shadows obscuring the surroundings.

- **Attract Mode:**

- **Big Bad:** The series has **two antagonists**. Marvin V. Mark is the primary, in-game threat, as he is **Care** and s abusive father (and kidnapper in Care's case) who wants to  and all the mysterious happenings in the game tie back to him. In the real world, .

- **Big Bad Ensemble:** Marvin V. Mark is the primary, in-game threat, as he is **Care** and s abusive father (and kidnapper in Care's case) who wants to , and all the mysterious happenings in the game tie back to him. In the real world, .

- **Body Motifs:** Eyebrows are very focused on throughout the series. Paul even changes Care's face in the Child Library for the sole reason that "eyebrows seem to be important."

- **Bookends:**

- **Breather Episode:** Petscop 21 is simply a recording of Care playing the game and "dancing" around in-game. It turns out that the video **syncs up**  with the **Ace of Base** song "The Sign."

Considering the [numerous lore-heavy episodes released on the same day](#), it's definitely a relief.

- **Brick Joke:**

- Paul is unable to catch one of the pets (Toneth) in Petscop 1 due to them not being in Even Care, otherwise capturing everything else available (except Roneth) before heading to the Newmaker Plane - where the rest of the series takes place, and any business about pets and catching them is long forgotten. In Petscop 6, after a very tense scene, Toneth finally appears in the Newmaker Plane, and Paul is able to catch it.

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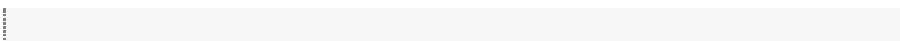
- Petscop 19 has a few in regards to the 1st episode. 



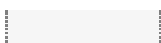
- **Bystander Syndrome:** In Petscop 5, the pink tool's responses beg Paul to turn off the PlayStation, and tell him that Marvin picks tool up and hurts an unnamed individual while it continues to run. Paul seems to shrug the warnings off as the game pretending to be haunted, and it's implied that Paul keeps the console on for the entire series, the most egregious example being when he leaves the game alone for four hours, recording it the entire time, to fulfill the red tool's earlier request to keep watching the windmill.

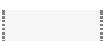
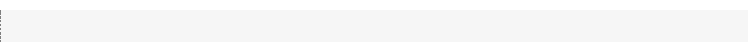
- **Call-Back:**

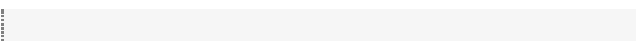
- Petscop 9 has Paul finally become the "shadow monster man" by going down the stairs of the Flower Shack and turning right at the very end.
- Petscop 11 has Paul try to open the door to the house after unlocking it, only to be told his [character](#) still cannot open doors, just like what happened in the first video when he tried to open a closed door.

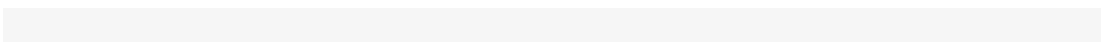
- Petscop 14 finally features 



- Petscop 19 and 24 prove that  is indeed a "Petscop kid" and "very smart."

- Petscop 20 shows what  did when the secret code from Petscop 1 was entered. It also features a call back to Petscop 5 and 6: Paul notices that the camera has changed positions; in 20, 

- In [the secret ending](#) of the Soundtrack video, 



- **Captain Obvious:** When Paul happens upon Michael Hammond's grave, marked 1988-1995, he remarks "that's a dead kid."

- **Cartoon Creature:** We have this in two instances.

- One is with a pet named "Pen", and, while we have a clue as to what a few other pets are (Amber is a ball, Toneth is a bird, Randice is a flower, Wavey is a cloud, and Roneth is some weird combo), it's hard to describe what Pen is. Her torso appears to be a closed umbrella,

she looks something like a doll, or, given her connection with mathematics, she looks like a scale (see [here](#)) but there isn't too much in real life one can compare her to, besides that she has a face.

- Paul's player character, "Newmaker". It's pretty hard to say what he is.

- **Censor Box:** Whoever is uploading to the channel is censoring objects and presumably cutting out footage. Petscop 7 ended with a message listing objects to be censored in future videos and that they can't state their reasons for doing so at the time.

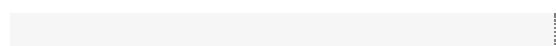
- In Petscop 7, it was an object on a table in a child's room - whatever it was confused Paul.



- In Petscop 9, the big present appears. Instead of censoring the box itself, what's censored is the giant, red, upside-down, spinning pyramid that comes out of it; the object seems to disturb Paul, who [makes this evident](#).

- In Petscop 10, the red tool's answer to Paul's question "Where was the windmill?" is censored. This is never revealed, unlike the others, but it is hinted to have been a set of coordinates that were too close to wherever Paul is.

- In Petscop 14, something on the wall of Care's house is censored.



- In Petscop 16, the phone number that the game provides is censored, although the area code can be briefly glimpsed during a transition. It points to Southern Connecticut, possibly where the series takes place.

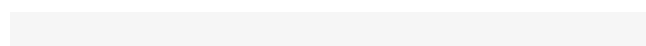
- **Central Theme:** The game has heavy themes of child abuse, especially in adopted families, and the monstrosity of it. In particular, the game seems to depict those who believe adopting children is the same thing as getting a pet that must obey your every command.

- **Chekhov's Gun:**

- In Petscop 1, Paul's note describes how to "walk downstairs and, in the bottom, turn right instead of proceeding" to become a "shadow monster man." Paul ignores this, instead repeating a cheat code to enter the Newmaker Plane. Eight videos later,



- Paul catches the moving tool in a later part of the game by luring it into the bucket.



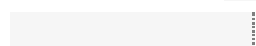
- **Closing Credits:**

- **Colour-Coded for Your Convenience:** To help identify certain characters, they are represented with color coded text:

- The tool is red, unless it turns pink, [in which it is pink](#).



- Care is yellow.



- Marvin is heavily associated with green.
- Anna is blue.
- Tiara/[REDACTED] is purple.

◦ [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

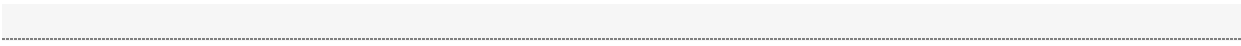
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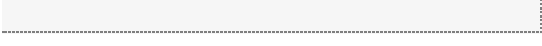
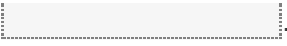
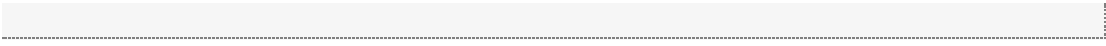
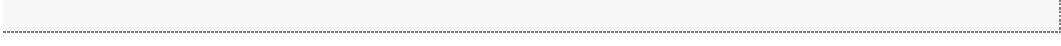
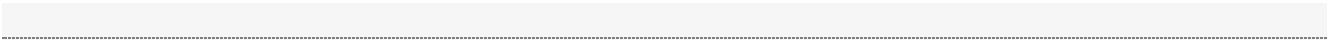
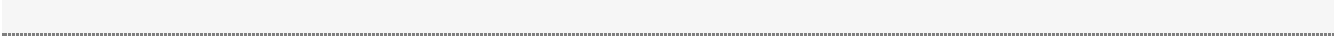
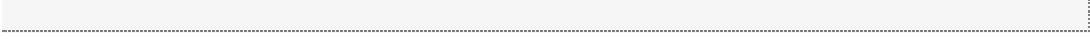
- **Creator Cross-References:** There are a few throwbacks to Domineco's previous project *Nifty*, such as re-used tiles and sounds. *In-Universe*, Garalina was also the creator of *Nift* as well as *Petscop*.
- **Darker and Edgier:** *Petscop* goes from a fun (albeit unfinished) game about collecting pets and finding their homes to a dark and twisted story (possibly) inspired by the [real-life child killings](#) [2] that happened as a result of [rebirthing therapy](#) [2].
- **Dark World:** The Newmaker Plane is a larger and darker world underneath the Gift Plane, with many locations and puzzles corresponding to the Even Care puzzles.
- **Death of a Child:**
 - Michael Hammond, who lived from 1988 to 1995, which would make him six or seven years old at the time of death. His tombstone is found in video 2, along with the inscription "Mike was a gift."
 - [REDACTED]
- **Disappeared Dad:** While Paul has mentioned his mother two times, he never refers to his father. Although, [REDACTED]
- **Disguised Horror Story:** *Petscop* is a fictional *Let's Play* series wherein Paul plays what starts as a fun ([albeit unfinished](#)) game about collecting pets and finding them homes, with a colorful environment called the Gift Plane, happy music, and overall looking every bit like the kid-friendly time-waster that was so common in the PS1 era. There are a few hints of something off (like the fact that the pets are scared of the [Player Character](#)), but it seems harmless. Until, that is, Paul enters a cheat code in Roneth's room. The music [suddenly stops](#), and Paul ventures outside Even Care to find not the peaceful-looking Gift Plane, but a darker, mysterious new world called the Newmaker Plane. From then on, *Petscop* moves to a dark and twisted story involving themes like child abuse, references to the tragic [Candace Newmaker](#) [2] incident, and cryptic events that increasingly seem like [REDACTED] is a key figure in.
- **Does This Remind You of Anything?:**
 - In Even Care, there are signs about bringing pets home. Two of them say "When choosing pets, pick **somebody** that you like. You don't have to love them right away," and "Don't be discouraged if they run from you! They really want a home. They're afraid. Show them there's nothing to be afraid of." It's worth mentioning that in *Petscop* 9, the sign changes from 'find

somebody that you like' to 'find *one* that you like'. This language far more resembles adoptive children than pets.

- There's a pet who's kept in a cage, and is awarded for staying there. Her description is "Amber is a young ball. She's afraid to leave home. If her home is good, this is not a problem. She is very heavy, and that makes her life a little harder, as well as yours. What's the safest place you can put her in? You should start thinking about that." In *hindsight*, the reactive attachment disorder themes were there from the beginning.
- "Child Library accepts **people**." Paul gives Care NLM—a haggard-looking child—to the Child Library despite knowing that he can turn her into Care A, a happier version. It can easily be seen as an allegory for (adoptive) parents who "give up" on their child and "give them back" rather than raise and treat them properly. He immediately enters her room and "catches" her again, suggesting that he was simply testing the Child Library's return slot.
- **Doppelgänger**: A recurring theme in the series, likely related to the "rebirthing" process. Some characters possess doubles who are strangely and contradictorily identical to them:
 - The biggest example is [redacted]. They have the same facial features and are the exact same age. [redacted] has no recollection of [redacted], though it seems that others do.
 - Care may be [redacted]
- **Double Take**: [redacted] does one in Petscop 20. The picture of the [redacted] is the only one he looks at twice - he approaches it, examines it, exits out, stands there for a few seconds, and then examines it again. The scene cuts before we get to see what he does afterwards.
- **Driven to Suicide**: In an example very much *not* played for laughs, Rainer is heavily implied to have killed himself immediately after giving Petscop to "The Family".

Fuck you all, and fuck me as well. Check your bathroom now.
- **Drone of Dread**: Tends to play whenever Paul stares at the windmill.
- **Dual-World Gameplay**: As Paul discovers, things he does in the Gift Plane/Even Care affect things in the Newmaker Plane. For example, catching Care NLM in the Newmaker Plane requires him to go to Pen's room in Even care and set the interval meter to -1.
- **Everyone Is Related**:
 - [redacted]
 - Curiously subverted with [redacted]; why exactly she is the only one in the game not to fit this pattern is unknown. What makes this even stranger is that [redacted]. It is suggested that she is adopted, meaning she is not *biologically* a part of the family.

- **Exact Words:** For a long time, the description of the Petscop channel (believed to have been written by the mysterious Family running the channel) read as follows: "The purpose of this YouTube channel is to preserve and display the recordings within the video game "Petscop" while keeping some of their content private." Note the use of the phrase "recordings *within* the video game," rather than "recordings *of* the video game." 



- **Fictional Video Game:** The titular *Petscop* is a PlayStation 1 game made by the fictional company Garalina. It is a puzzle-exploration game where the Guardian must go through 8 levels and catch the creatures known as Pets, solving puzzles to catch them. The game is unfinished and unreleased- Paul got it through 
- **Flower Motifs:** The series has Care associated with daisies, which is both a reference to *Daisy-head Mayzie* (and *Loves Me Not*) and how 

- **Foolish Sibling, Responsible Sibling:** According to their descriptions, Roneth is the responsible to Toneth's foolish because he learns from the latter's mistakes and doesn't need to be watched all the time (implying that Toneth does need to be watched all the time).
- **Freeze-Frame Bonus:**
 - In Petscop 19, a couple of times, the pause menu appears for a second before the game screen zooms in and covers it completely. Pausing at the right time (if you need help, the "comma" and "period" keys make the video advance by one frame at the time) it's possible to see that the text under the score changed:
 - At 2:03, the text became 
 - At 3:15, it became 
 - In Petscop 23, at 4:12, some pink text can be seen that reads 

- **The Ghost:**
 - Michael Hammond and Tiara, unlike Care (who has a few depictions of her in-game), however, Michael does have his face on a tombstone.
 - Rainer, the developer (or one of them), who's also serving as *The Voice*, as he only gets mentioned by Paul and we see his notes in-game.
 - Marvin was this initially, as Tool (turned pink), says, "Marvin picks up tool and hurts me when PlayStation on."
- **Guide Dang It!: In-Universe** variant. Paul cannot figure out how to catch Roneth- every time he approaches Roneth in his room, the pet simply flies away, then returns once Paul's character backs up a bit. It takes until Petscop 13, a whole *year* later, for him to figure out how to do it- 




- **Haunted Technology:** Many fans believe this is the source of the game's strangeness, but Paul himself **subverts this trope**, expressing his belief that it's not "ghosts," but that the happenings are pre-recorded. It was left ambiguous [REDACTED]
[REDACTED] As of Petscop 14, [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
- **Hidden Villain:** In video 5, a character named "Marvin" is revealed, who is described as hitting a child, Mike, with a tool for having his **PlayStation** on. From this it can be assumed he is an evil person, but there is not much else known about Marvin. In video 8, however, a representation of Marvin seems to appear — and he looks the exact same as the player character's sprite, but with some sort of green object replacing/covering the head.
- **Holiday Episode:** Many of the episode uploads have occurred on special days, with the involved episodes slightly themed around that holiday:
 - **Christmas Episode:** **Petscop 11** was uploaded on Christmas Day, 2017. Apart from a house with a Christmas tree in it, this video is devoid of actually celebrating the holiday, to the point that [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
 - **Halloween Episode:** Petscop 16 was released to YouTube on 10/31/2018, which is Halloween. Despite its short duration, its content was quite disturbing.
 - Petscop 17 to 21 were uploaded on Easter, 2019. The episodes were themed around Easter eggs, showing in-universe behind-the-scenes.
 - Petscop 22 to 24 were uploaded on Labor Day, 2019. This holiday is also associated with the first day of school, and the episodes were focused on the school which had sometimes appeared in previous episodes.
 - Petscop Soundtrack was uploaded on American Thanksgiving, 2019. On Twitter, Tony thanked everyone who had followed the story to its completion, and released the soundtrack to YouTube and Bandcamp in return.
- **Identical Stranger:** The series draws a heavy amount of parallels between Paul and Care. They share a birth date, the same facial features and [REDACTED]
[REDACTED] The nature of their similarities is never elaborated upon beyond implications.
- **In-Character Let's Play:** The game is initially styled as a Let's Play narrated by the fictional Paul.
- **Interface Screw:** In Petscop 7, while in the Quitter's Room, Paul hears the usual ominous short chiptune from his left speaker and goes to find Tiara gone.
- **Kidnapped by Family:** It's revealed [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
- **Lampshade Hanging:**

- The first few episodes contain things that are typical for a story about a video game that is haunted. From graves, to weird messages, to just being creepy. Near the end of Petscop 6, Paul does a long talk addressing this, talking about how the game is trying to seem haunted, and he addresses things like the hidden messages, and basically says [he doesn't buy it](#).

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- [Let's Play](#): The series is in the style of one, and is essentially a fictional Let's Play for a [Fictional Video Game](#). Paul, the one playing the game, gives his commentary on the odd and disturbing content, and is recording the videos to show to an unseen friend of his.
- [Lie to the Beholder](#): Inverted: Players of [Petscop](#) see the Guardian (the [Player Character](#)) as a [Cartoon Creature](#) with a chubby green head. When others see them, the green head is something completely different that seems to be unique for all individual players. (Tiara is a crudely-drawn girl, Marvin is a green face and Paul is)
- [Living Shadow](#): The "Shadow Monster Man," implied to be Marvin. In early episodes, he was only seen as a pitch black figure roaming the Newmaker Plane. In Petscop 9, .
- [Loves Me Not](#): There is a large daisy in a shed. As Paul plucks its petals, the girl it is connected to in the room next to it distorts (i.e ending on the conclusion of 'loves me not', or rather, 'nobody loves me'). Later on, it turns out that the threadmill is connected to it, and setting it to -1 (i.e changing the outcome to 'loves me') allows Paul to finally acquire the girl. It's even lampshaded that you needed to lie (as a flower obviously has no -1 petals) to get her.
 - As the words 'good grief and alas' are found elsewhere, it is likely to refer to [Daisy-Head Mayzie](#).
- [Ludicrous Precision](#): Petscop 12 reveals how long the game has been played down to the second. Or, to be more specific, .
- [Madness Mantra](#): Toneth's description ends like this, with his name being repeated over and over again.

I guess that's toneth then. toneth toneth toneth toneth toneth toneth toneth toneth toneth toneth toneth toneth toneth toneth toneth toneth.
- [Magic Music](#): Songs played on the Needles Piano are this, implied to be the final step of the "rebirthing" process. There are two known songs, whose titles are revealed via subtitles:
 - The song played in Petscop 11 (which Paul also hums in Petscop 14) is "Care's melody."
 - The song played in Petscop 23 is "Paul's melody."
- [Meaningful Echo](#): When , the text says "Care left the room," just like the text in video 2 that said the same thing.

- **Meaningful Name:** Tiara was the middle name of Candace Newmaker, the girl whose tragic death was alluded to in earlier episodes.
- **Mercy Kill:** Toneth's description has a story about a person whose dog gets hit by a car and survives, and they end up being the only person who **still wants to put it down**. This story ends up **going off the text box because of how long it is**.
It makes me think about the dog actually. Because when the car hit him I thought "at least it will be over soon." He survived it, and I was the only one who still wanted to put him down.
- **Mind Screw:** The cryptic writing and puzzles are strange enough, but things start to really get into this territory when inexplicable anomalies happen, such as the game perfectly mimicking the player's movements *before* they've performed them. In general the story and backstory are incredibly ambiguous and strange even as the series gives more and more content to work with.
- **Mickey Mousing:** Petscop 21 syncs up perfectly with the classic **Ace of Base** hit "The Sign."
- **Mirror Routine/The Mirror Shows Your True Self:**

- Mirrors, and mirrored actions, are a repeating motif. The Quitter's Room has Tiara on one side and Paul on the other, their movements synced, *most of the time*.

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- **Mons:** The game appears to have a focus on collecting strange creatures referred to as Pets.
- **Mood Whiplash:**
 - When Paul catches Toneth in video 6, the same fun, colorful animation that played in video 1 whenever he caught a pet appears, clashing with the dark ambience that's been shown ever since Paul entered the Newmaker Plane.
 - The pause screen remains the same as it was from the beginning, bright and pink.
 - In Petscop 2, when Paul has exited the Child Library, he decides to explore whatever is to the right... only to find a void.
Paul: We're still not done, because we still have whatever is over here. Or not. Okay.
 - A small part of Petscop 9 involves "Paul" going back to the original beginning of the game, before he entered the Newmaker Plane.
- **Moon Logic Puzzle:** In-universe.

- **Mr. Exposition:** "Tool" is the closest thing to an expositor we have.
- **Newhart Phonecall:** Played *very much* for tension, where Paul has often called the original intended recipient of his videos. We never hear their voice, and all we know for sure about them is that they are not "part of 'The Family'", and as such, do not have a room in the Child Library.
- **No Brows:** Care has no eyebrows.
- **No Name Given:** This applies to both the uploader of the videos and the game's protagonist. There is no clear name given to either of them. At the beginning of the first video, the uploader names his save file "Paul", but it is unclear whether it is his own name or the name he wants to give to the protagonist. For the protagonist, in video 5, the strange artifact known as "TOOL" answers the question "Who am I?" with "Newmaker". This answer is vague, as TOOL is not clear *who* is named "Newmaker". Despite this, fans have just taken to referring to both the uploader of the videos and game protagonist as "Paul". In order to differentiate between the uploader of the videos and the game protagonist, a popular solution is to refer to the video uploader as "Paul" and the game protagonist as "Naul", a combination of "Newmaker" and "Paul".
- **Non Sequitur:** The incredibly disturbing description of Toneth, complete with **Madness Mantra**, ends with the words, "it's yucky outside."
- **Noodle Incident:**
 - The windmill's disappearance in 1977 mentioned in Petscop 9. It's not really said what happened, besides that the windmill disappeared and Anna's sister didn't come back with them, either. However, the video implies that it was a crime (which is interpreted to be a murder), and that Marvin had a hand in it.
 - Why the Gift Plane staff left isn't said and neither is it said if they left of their own accord, if something happened, or if they simply weren't programmed into the game. Likewise, we don't really know what happened to the other forty-three pets besides the ones we see.
 - How Michael Hammond died isn't known either. There was something that happened between Marvin and Rainer, which is hinted to be related to this.
 -
- **Nothing Is Scariest:** This whole playthrough has much of the "Nothing At All" type.
 - As of Petscop 13, nothing seen in a typical horror game or creepypasta is present, aside from darkness and disturbing text. Usually, the only source of light emanates from the player character, making every room unusually disturbing. Even when the room is lit, there's always something very off about how the room looks; especially, the school.

- We don't know what the black boxes were censoring in Petscop 7 and 9. All we know is that it noticeably shocked and confused Paul, based on the shakiness in his voice afterwards. He talks less and less after this event. The censor in Petscop 9 is strong enough for a [Precision F-Strike](#).

- At the end of Petscop 22, the Guardian enters the basement of the school. A [Drone of Dread](#) plays as Guardian walks through a doorway on the left. The camera pans over increment by increment and [the video ends before we see what is there](#). The atmosphere is crushingly brutal.

- In Petscop 23,

- [Ominous Visual Glitch:](#)

- Throughout the series, composite video artifacts cause some visual elements to flicker or distort in various ways. The most famous example is in the first installment, when Paul is putting in his name, and the button options are below. The Triangle button is shown to mean "Go Back" this seems like it means if you press that button, you'll go back, but the triangle is fluttering, almost like it's scared. This can be seen as a warning, telling the player to go back.

- In Petscop 2,

- [\[redacted\]](#) appears to randomly move throughout the series. This is probably caused by nearest-neighbor filtering on the texture.

- Near the end of Petscop 5, when Paul is wrapping up, his avatar's face and body and the area around it suddenly glitches a bit, and it kind of looks like the avatar's face is melted. This is most likely a video compression artifact.

- In Petscop 15 around 2:50, when the avatar is sitting on a chair, for a split second, a small amount of a copy of the avatar appears to the right of it. This is likely caused by a video compression artifact.

- [Precision F-Strike](#): While relatively rare, the series does contain a few f-bombs, both from [Paul's commentary](#) and from the [supposedly kid-friendly game](#) itself.

- Whatever Paul saw in Petscop 9 (the object is censored) has him give this reaction:

Paul: What the fuck?

- Care A's description, written by [\[redacted\]](#), gets one in Petscop 11:

Fuck you all, and fuck me as well. [Merry Christmas](#).

- In Petscop 14, when [\[redacted\]](#), Paul emits a single "fuck" right before the video ends.

- In Petscop 22, the game delivers one through a text box- a character who can be assumed to be Care says to Jill "stop fucking ignoring me".
- In Petscop 23, [REDACTED].
- **Production Throwback:** One which flew under the community's radar for over a year, due to the creator's anonymity, is buried in Petscop 15: [REDACTED] tells the player to "Press Nifty" to unlock the texture editor. *Nifty* turns out to be the name of a previous game made by the creator of *Petscop*.^{note}
- **Punctuated! For! Emphasis!:** Due to the way the in-game communication system works ^{note}, every sentence made by a player is presented as this. [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED] Thanks. [REDACTED]
- **Recycled Soundtrack:**
 - One sound effect in Petscop is recycled from Tony's old project *Nifty*. Also the song "explore" is a revamped version of a song from *Nifty*, with the song "explore-min" mixed in.
 - The **Credits Medley** is just the bass and drum parts of the song "level1."
- **Red Herring:** The real-life **Candace Newmaker case** [REDACTED] is referenced a few times early in the series. While it originally led many to view the game as re-exploring the child abuse involved in that case, it became clear by Petscop 11 that the series was more of an exploration of the damage done to children by adoptive and ex-parents who treat them more like objects than people, and that all Newmaker references were merely easily digestible allusions to fill in the hidden game's setting. [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
- **Retcon:** The reveal of the **Player Character's** name as "Guardian" instead of "Newmaker" is most likely one, considering that **Tony considers the references to the Candace Newmaker case** [REDACTED] an **Old Shame**. The term Newmaker was phased out before Petscop 10.
- **The Reveal:**
 - Petscop 11 reveals a good chunk of the backstory when the house and school are finally discovered. [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
 - Petscop 14 drops the bombshell that [REDACTED]
 - Petscop 17 through 20 are essentially **reveal after reveal after reveal**, including [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]. We also see what happened during [REDACTED]'s playthrough of the game: [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED].
 - Petscop 22 reveals the person on the other end of Paul's phone call is [REDACTED] (by way of the subtitles.) [REDACTED]

- Petscop 23 gives us Tiara's last name.

- **Riddle for the Ages:** The series has **tons** of this. The series' surreal, almost dreamlike narrative, combined with the fact that the story takes the form of an in-universe Let's Play being recorded by an **Unreliable Narrator**, means that huge chunks of the plot are left up to the reader to interpret. Some of the major ones include:
 - What happened between Marvin, Anna, and _____ years ago that supposedly caused both the windmill and _____ to disappear and _____ to later be reborn as her sister's daughter? Did those things actually happen at all, or is it just something Rainer falsely believes? The only concrete clue we get comes in Episode 17, when _____, which only raises further questions.
 - During Episode 14, the game poses a riddle to the player: there are two photos side by side. In the first one, the door is closed, while in the second one, taken later, it is open. However, no one opened the door, the door didn't open by itself, and in fact the door didn't open at all. How is this possible? The game never provides an answer to this riddle, and it's implied to be something only _____ would know the answer to.
 - What ultimately happened to **Marvin**? It's unclear whether the in-game version of him is a **Virtual Ghost** or simply an AI replica of him based on his saved gameplay (although the series seems to lean slightly towards the latter), and while Episode 23 does feature the in-game version of Marvin _____, we have no evidence at all as to what happened to the real world Marvin.
- **Room Full of Crazy:** Petscop 20 states Marvin stenciled all over the walls in a room and after he was kicked out of the house, Anna had to paint the entire room black to cover it up.
- **Same Surname Means Related:** The series often uses **Given Name Reveals** with the last names "Mark" and "Leskowitz". Of course, given that this is an In-Universe case of both **Write Who You Know** and retelling events, this is **justified**.
- **Scare Chord:** In Petscop 2, when Paul looks at the picture of the school, a sound of dread and foreboding plays. _____
- **Self-Deprecation:** The creator of the series is known as Tony. In the Book of Baby Names, Tony is credited as a "dummy."
- **Shout-Out:**
 - The phrases "good grief and alas" and "nobody loves me" are each a reference to **Daisy-Head Mayzie** by **Dr. Seuss**. As is the large daisy in the shed in the Newmaker Plane _____
 - "Sit here for the present," which Marvin says in Petscop 15, is a reference to **Ramona the Pest** by **Beverly Cleary**. This book is referenced again in Petscop 24, where the name "Ramona" is linked to "pest."

- In Petscop 21, the movements of Guardian (presumably controlled by Care) [perfectly sync up with](#)  "The Sign" by [Ace of Base](#). The video's description even consists solely of the song's title. Funnily enough, the 21st word of that song (disregarding the intro) is "care".
- In Petscop 24, there is a list of names, each associated with a word. Mike is associated with "painter." mike_painter65 is one of the posters in the forum thread that comprises the text of [Candle Cove](#).

• [Sound Test](#):              

• [Special Thanks](#):                                              

• [Stealth Pun](#): Petscop 21 has Care dancing to "The Sign" by [Ace of Base](#). As she does so, she repeatedly runs circles around the wooden signs in her room, clearly aware of the pun.

• [The Stinger](#): At the end of the soundtrack video is                          

• [The Stoic](#): Despite all the crazy stuff he sees, Paul manages to keep a calm attitude most of the time. Key word being [most](#).

• [Subverted Kids' Show](#): Petscop seems to be the type of game you might have played in your childhood going by the first level- cute pets to catch, puzzles, and a happy atmosphere- but when Paul enters the cheat code he found and exits the level, he finds himself in a dark void/grassland, and as the game progresses it becomes more [subtly creepy](#) and depressing with themes and allusions to child abuse. Also, there is [infrequent but strong swearing](#), both from Paul and from the game itself.

• [Take That, Audience!](#): A debate ensued over the final scene of Petscop 13, in which Paul is instructed to leave the PlayStation on, as he has completed the game. Fans theorized he was either exiting or being forced into a car. In Petscop 22, at one point Paul says, "What? Why would I be in a car? I'm playing Petscop. Why would I be playing Petscop in a car?" Subverted in that when the creator added in subtitles for Petscop 13,                          

• [Timey-Wimey Ball](#): The inconsistent timeline and rules about time travel are intentionally done to increase the mystery and ambiguity that the series thrives on.

- A windmill disappeared in 1977, along with a girl.                           

- The channel's description during the hiatus between Petscop 10 and 11 persistently referred to                                                        

- The house is                                                 

-                                                          

- **Trouble Entendre:** The Family, after taking over the Petscop YouTube channel, say that Paul is recording himself at their "strong suggestion," and that although he had "issues with the arrangement, these have finally been settled." It is never clarified what this means, but given that Paul does not seem to trust the Family, it is indicated that [REDACTED]
- **Two Aliases, One Character:** [REDACTED] and Tiara are the same person.
- **Unexpected Gameplay Change:** The school area shifts the perspective from third-person to first-person.
- **Unexpectedly Realistic Gameplay:** In the first video/level, Paul tries to open an unopened door. But being that the **Player Character** is an **Armless Biped**, the textbox informs Paul that he cannot open doors. This happens again in Petscop 11, when he tries to open the door to enter the house.
- **Unknown Character:**
 - There is mention of a wife, a husband and someone who is addressed by "Paul". In Episode 6 "Paul" finds out there are four more "Pets", while three of them are different versions of Care, the last one isn't even pictured.
 - Micheal Hammond, however, he's *dead*, so there isn't much to know about besides a few details shown.
 - The Proprietors of the YouTube channel.
 - There's Rainer. From what we do know, he created the titular *Petscop* game and he has some connection to Marvin but that's about it. [REDACTED]
 - Jill is someone Paul knows and she has a connection to the Wife in-game but we know nothing about her. Later in the series, [REDACTED]
- **The Un-Reveal:**
 - The message on the chalkboard is not shown uncensored, but is described as a message of five words.
 - The red tool's answer to "Where was the windmill?" remains censored but is implied by dialogue to be a pair of co-ordinates [REDACTED].
 - In Petscop 22, Paul goes down a flight of stairs and turns to the room on his character's right. The camera slowly pans to whatever is in that room... and then freezes before it gets there, and the video ends.
- **The Very Definitely Final Dungeon:** [REDACTED] is the final area Paul visits in Petscop 22 and 23, and while it is visited in prior videos, it is where the climax takes place.
- **Video Game Cruelty Potential:** Paul does some morally ambiguous actions with the pets:
 - Paul deceives Amber to catch her.
 - He plays "Love Me, Love Me Not" with a daisy, affecting Care in a different room. It lands on "Love Me Not," leaving her a crying, disfigured mess.

- Later, it's revealed he has to "lie" by manipulating the flower to have another petal.
- He's eventually able to catch Care A. However, the process involves
- In Petscop 5, Paul is asking the tool questions, when it suddenly turns pink. Paul tries to ask a question and he get this: "TURN OFF PLAYSTATION" He asks why, and it responds with "MARVIN PICKS UP TOOL HURTS ME WHEN PLAYSTATION ON." This is a disturbing response, implying someone is getting hurt when the PlayStation is on. But Paul ignores it. It's heavily implied that the PlayStation has been on the entire series. Paul is letting this suffering continue. The game itself supports this suffering. At the end of Petscop 13, after all the Pets are caught, Paul gets a message, one that ends with this: "Please leave the PlayStation on when you leave. You can stand up now." Also In Petscop 16, this message appears: "No controller input has been detected for a very long time. Family, neighbors, police, (or whoever,) [KEEP GAME CONSOLE RUNNING,] Call provided phone number."

- **Villain Episode:**
- **The Voice:** As the premise is "someone recording videos of a game they found", we never get to see Paul, the player that provides commentary.
- **Wall Bonking:** Marvin does this in Petscop 8 before glitching out of bounds.
- **Wall of Text:** Toneth's description has two of these that go off the text box. One of them is about someone wanting to **put down a dog** after it's been hit by a car, and the other is a repeat of the word 'toneth' 17 times before ending with 'the end' and '**it's yucky outside**'.
- **Weirdness Censor:** In episode 6, a four hour long cutscene occurs, involving the windmill and a randomly generating environment, which includes ominous text. Paul's only comment is that it was neat that the windmill reversed directions.
- **Wham Episode:** Petscop 11 marks a definitive shift in tone from the first 10 episodes. Beforehand, there were hints that the game might be haunted and trying to communicate to Paul; in Petscop 11 we learn that
- **Wham Line:** A number of them.
 - For most of the first few episodes, the game is eerie but not necessarily disturbing; Paul is simply exploring a dimly-lit space under the main game, with the occasional momentary surprise or cryptic event. The pink tool's first line in Petscop 5 *immediately* puts that to rest.
TURN OFF PLAYSTATION
 - In Petscop 8, Paul reveals that
Paul: Well, it could have changed between then and 2004.
 - Paul's first spoken lines in Petscop 11 reveal that

Paul: ...when I found _____... I was shocked at first, but it made sense. Especially considering where I found the game in the first place... that it'd be _____

- Also in Petscop 11, the line "I met him at a birthday party once." _____

- Petscop 12 seems to hint _____

Note Writer: I'm calling you _____ because that's who you are. You might be confused as to what happened. _____

- In Petscop 13, we get the reveal that _____

- In Petscop 14, after _____ Paul decides to bring something up:

Paul: ...I think... ...I think... ...I think... ...that was based... off of a... conversation... that _____

- Just about *everything* that is said in Petscop 17 is one of these.

- In Petscop 23, Marvin asks Paul what room he's in, and Paul shows him it.

Marvin: Thanks

- **Wham Shot:**

- _____
- _____
- _____

- **What Measure Is a Non-Human?:** The pets are initially referred to as "*somebody* that you love." Upon Paul's second visit to the Gift Plane, however, the sign has changed to saying to pick "**one** that you love." Also, the Child Library will not accept most of them, as it only accepts people- the three versions of Care are the only thing it will accept.

- **Windmill Scenery:** One of the main mysteries is an example of this trope. It keeps disappearing, it rotates the opposite way multiple times, and it's an integral plot point. Apparently even mentioning the location is enough to [get censored](#).

- **Write Who You Know:** In-universe. The series deals with several horrific events that went unpunished being recreated in the titular game by Rainer to expose Marvin and The Family. While several of these people can be found in some metaphorical way, Marvin is the most prominent as the green-headed Guardian. _____

- [You Have GOT to Be Kidding Me!](#): In Petscop 9, Paul says this when he is finally able to enter the windmill after his character became a "shadow monster man," when previously the windmill would disappear whenever he went near it.
- [Zero-Effort Boss](#): The giant object at the top floor of the school with several pieces spinning around it is apparently an in-game boss going by the subtitles (which refer to the noises it makes as "boss noises"), but it never attacks Paul or even moves, and Paul is able to "beat" it just by pressing the interact button once. The game has no combat system to speak of as it is a puzzle exploration game, so this is justified, but it is odd that the creator would call this thing a boss at all. ^{note}

Tropes exclusive to *Giftscop*:

- [Artistic License](#):
 - Since the player is not, [in fact](#), playing with Marvin, the needles piano will spawn automatically after some time in the parts where it appears.
 - The scene in Petscop 11 with the ramp in the bathroom is not implemented, since what exactly happens when Paul touches the symbol block is unclear.
- [Defictionalization](#): The entire game is this for *Petscop*, which was a [Fictional Video Game](#). There is even a [PS1 homebrew](#)  version of Giftscop.
- [Easter Egg](#): Several can be found by typing "extras" on the title screen.
- [Unintentionally Unwinnable](#): Generations 1 and 2 have no pause menu, no generation-changing events, and no way to exit Even Care, so if you load an Even Care save in one of those generations, you can't get back to the Newmaker Plane without switching generations.

[TURN OFF TVTROPES](#)

Alternative Title(s): Giftscop

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